FORMS OF GOVERNMENT

THE CENTRAL QUESTION OF — PLATO: THE DEGENERATION SEQUENCE — ARISTOTLE'S SIX-FOLD MATRIX AND — MONARCHY: TWO TYPES, FOUR — THEOCRACY: DIVINE SOVEREIGNTY, THE — DEMOCRACY: THE MODEL TAXONOMY

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FORM · SUBORDINATE EXTRA · APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g5 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00 STAGE 00 — THE CENTRAL QUESTION OF REGIME CLASSIFICATION AND ITS FOUR AXES

THE CENTRAL QUESTION OF REGIME CLASSIFICATION AND ITS FOUR… · BY WHAT TITLE MAY ONE ARRANGEMENT OF RULE BIND · FOUR AXES, NEVER ONE · (1) WHO RULES? one · (2) FOR WHOSE GOOD? COMMON GOOD <— PRIVATE OR… · (3) BY WHAT TITLE? HEREDITY · DIVINE SANCTION CONSENT AND ELECTION · SACRED LAW

CENTRAL QUESTION — by what title may one arrangement of rule bind everyone in a

FOUR AXES, NEVER ONE

(1) WHO RULES? one

(2) FOR WHOSE GOOD? common good <— private or sectional interest

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CENTRAL QUESTION — by what title may one arrangement of rule bind everyone in a territory, and on what grounds may that arrangement be judged?
- FOUR AXES, NEVER ONE
- (1) WHO RULES? one
- (2) FOR WHOSE GOOD? common good <— private or sectional interest
- (3) BY WHAT TITLE? heredity

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- divine sanction consent and election
- sacred law
- (4) UNDER WHAT LIMITS? law? rights? accountability? none at all?
- MONARCHY THEOCRACY DEMOCRACY rule of one, title is rule in the name of God, rule of the people
- heredity, tradition and title is revelation and title is consent, sometimes divine-right sacred law

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- read by clergy equality, participation danger: arbitrariness, danger: conscience crushed, danger: majoritarianism, unaccountability, a weak
- citizenship made unequal, manipulated opinion, basis in equality dissent read as impiety mediocrity, propaganda
- DESCRIPTIVE map (what a regime IS) vs NORMATIVE verdict (whether it OUGHT to bind)
- CONTROL — separate the four axes first, fix description or evaluation second, adjudicate last on a criterion you have already named.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — CENTRAL QUESTION — by what title may one arrangement of rule bind everyone in a territory, and on what grounds may that arrangement be judged?

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DESCRIPTIVE map (what a regime IS) vs NORMATIVE verdict (whether it OUGHT to bind).

01 STAGE 01 — PLATO: THE DEGENERATION SEQUENCE AND THE THREE CHARGES AGAINST DEMOCRACY

THE DEGENERATION SEQUENCE AND THE THREE CHARGES AGAINST DEMOCRACY · ROOT CLAIM · RULING IS A CRAFT REQUIRING KNOWLEDGE OF JUSTICE AND · SHIP OF STATE · NAVIGATION IS NOT HANDED TO THE UNSKILLED BECAUSE THEY · DEGENERATION OF CONSTITUTIONS (REPUBLIC) · EACH DOMINANT VALUE CORRUPTS INTO THE NEXT · ARISTOCRACY OF KNOWLEDGE → WISDOM RULES HONOUR DISPLACES WISDOM

ROOT CLAIM — ruling is a CRAFT requiring KNOWLEDGE of justice and the good → SHIP OF STATE — navigation is not handed to the unskilled because they are many → DEGENERATION OF CONSTITUTIONS (Republic): each dominant value corrupts into the next → ARISTOCRACY OF KNOWLEDGE → wisdom rules honour displaces wisdom → TIMOCRACY → honour and military spiritedness the desire for wealth displaces honour

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- ROOT CLAIM — ruling is a CRAFT requiring KNOWLEDGE of justice and the good
- SHIP OF STATE — navigation is not handed to the unskilled because they are many
- DEGENERATION OF CONSTITUTIONS (Republic): each dominant value corrupts into the next
- ARISTOCRACY OF KNOWLEDGE — wisdom rules honour displaces wisdom
- TIMOCRACY — honour and military spiritedness the desire for wealth displaces honour

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- OLIGARCHY — property and wealth; rich divided from poor the poor many overthrow the propertied few
- DEMOCRACY — freedom and equality of desires unrestrained license makes restraint itself look oppressive
- TYRANNY — one demagogue who flatters the many, then dominates them
- THREE CHARGES — [1] ruling is a craft, so numbers confer no competence
- [2] democracy mistakes LIBERTY for QUALIFICATION

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- [3] unregulated liberty breeds the demagogue, hence tyranny
- TRAP — this is NOT a defence of hereditary monarchy and NOT mere hatred of freedom
- VERDICT (asymmetric) — the diagnosis of demagoguery and defective leadership selection survives
- the guardian remedy fails for want of consent and correction.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT (asymmetric) — the diagnosis of demagoguery and defective leadership selection survives; the guardian remedy fails for want of consent and correction.

02 STAGE 02 — ARISTOTLE'S SIX-FOLD MATRIX AND THE POLITY AS THE PRACTICABLE MEAN

ARISTOTLE'S SIX-FOLD MATRIX AND THE POLITY AS THE PRACTICABLE… · TWO VARIABLES · (A) HOW MANY RULE (B) FOR WHOSE ADVANTAGE · NUMBER RULING · RIGHT FORM (COMMON GOOD) · DEVIATION (PRIVATE GAIN) · DEMOCRACY (CLASSICAL SENSE) · THE RIGHT AND CORRUPT VERSION OF EACH NUMBER DIFFER

NUMBER RULING	RIGHT FORM (common good)	DEVIATION (private gain)
ONE	MONARCHY	TYRANNY
FEW	ARISTOCRACY	OLIGARCHY
MANY	POLITY	DEMOCRACY (classical sense)

PLATO asks WHO OUGHT IDEALLY TO RULE · ARISTOTLE asks WHICH CONSTITUTION CAN

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- TWO VARIABLES — [A] HOW MANY RULE [B] FOR WHOSE ADVANTAGE
- NUMBER RULING
- RIGHT FORM (common good)
- DEVIATION (private gain)
- DEMOCRACY (classical sense)

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- the good MANY form is POLITY, and classical democracy is its DEVIATION
- POLITY — mixed constitution — rule of the many UNDER LAW, moderated by property, virtue,
- civic participation and a broad MIDDLE CLASS against STATISM — value is not absorbed into
- one all-wise ruler or state against INDIVIDUALISM — politics is not unrestricted private self-assertion for
- CIVIC MODERATION — citizenship inside a lawful order aimed at common good

EVALUATION / TRAP

- ARISTOTLE asks WHICH CONSTITUTION CAN
- SUSTAIN a good political life in practice
- LIMIT — common advantage is not self-specifying and needs an independent theory of the good
- the stability of polity is a sociological claim, not a proof.
- TRAP — polity is a mixed- government precursor, NOT universal-suffrage democracy.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP — polity is a mixed-government precursor, NOT universal-suffrage democracy.

03 STAGE 03 — MONARCHY: TWO TYPES, FOUR OBJECTIONS AND THE ABOVE-POLITICS TEST

TWO TYPES, FOUR OBJECTIONS AND THE ABOVE-POLITICS TEST · RULE BY ONE PERSON, NORMALLY HOLDING OFFICE BY HEREDITY · ABSOLUTE MONARCHY CONSTITUTIONAL MONARCHY EXECUTIVE, LEGISLATIVE AND SOMETIMES THE · HEREDITY, CONQUEST, TRADITION, HISTORIC CONTINUITY PLUS LEGAL · DIVINE RIGHT OF KINGS LIMITATION BY CONVENTION ACCOUNTABILITY · WEAK, UNSECURED ACCOUNTABILITY · CABINET, PARLIAMENT (APPARENT VERDICT) · EFFICIENT, NORMATIVELY RISKY VERDICT

DOCTRINE / CLAIM	OBJECTION / PRESSURE	REPLY / RESIDUAL
DEFINITION — rule by ONE person, normally holding office by HEREDITY	EQUALITY — public authority should be open to all on equal terms	the order ceases to be constitutional and slides toward arbitrary rule
ABSOLUTE MONARCHY CONSTITUTIONAL MONARCHY executive, legislative and sometimes the monarch REIGNS while elected judicial	MERIT — birth guarantees neither wisdom nor virtue	DIVINE RIGHT — the king rules by God's will and answers primarily to God a BRIDGE between monarchy and theocracy, never an identity of the two
power concentrated in one institutions GOVERN title: heredity, conquest, tradition, historic continuity plus legal	ACCOUNTABILITY — concentrated power invites arbitrariness and despotism	VERDICT — monarchy coexists with individual freedom only where CONSTITUTIONALISED
DIVINE RIGHT OF KINGS limitation by convention accountability: weak, unsecured accountability	FREEDOM — liberty needs law, rights and institutions, not a crown	as a principle of rule it does not by itself ground freedom.

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- DEFINITION — rule by ONE person, normally holding office by HEREDITY
- ABSOLUTE MONARCHY CONSTITUTIONAL MONARCHY executive, legislative and sometimes the monarch REIGNS while elected judicial
- power concentrated in one institutions GOVERN title: heredity, conquest, tradition, historic continuity plus legal
- DIVINE RIGHT OF KINGS limitation by convention accountability: weak, unsecured accountability
- cabinet, parliament verdict: efficient, normatively risky verdict: acceptable as symbolic head

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- EQUALITY — public authority should be open to all on equal terms
- MERIT — birth guarantees neither wisdom nor virtue
- ACCOUNTABILITY — concentrated power invites arbitrariness and despotism
- FREEDOM — liberty needs law, rights and institutions, not a crown
- THE ABOVE-POLITICS TEST above PARTY CONFLICT — systematic: the role is fixed by

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- the order ceases to be constitutional and slides toward arbitrary rule
- DIVINE RIGHT — the king rules by God's will and answers primarily to God a BRIDGE between monarchy and theocracy, never an identity of the two
- VERDICT — monarchy coexists with individual freedom only where CONSTITUTIONALISED
- as a principle of rule it does not by itself ground freedom.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: as a principle of rule it does not by itself ground freedom.

04 STAGE 04 — THEOCRACY: DIVINE SOVEREIGNTY, THE INTERPRETATION MONOPOLY AND VALIDITY

DIVINE SOVEREIGNTY, THE INTERPRETATION MONOPOLY AND VALIDITY · POLITICAL AUTHORITY CLAIMED IN THE NAME OF GOD, OF · NOT THE SAME AS · A SOCIETY MERELY INFLUENCED BY RELIGION, OR A MORALLY · FIVE STRUCTURAL FEATURES · SOVEREIGNTY OF GOD · FINAL AUTHORITY IS DIVINE WILL, NOT THE PEOPLE · SACRED LAW

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DEFINITION — political authority claimed in the name of GOD, of divine law, or of the authorised interpreters of sacred truth
- NOT the same as — a society merely INFLUENCED by religion, or a morally informed polity in which believers argue publicly as equal citizens
- FIVE STRUCTURAL FEATURES
- SOVEREIGNTY OF GOD — final authority is divine will, not the people
- SACRED LAW — religious law guides or determines civil law

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- CASE FOR
- CASE AGAINST moral unity and collective purpose
- no equal standing for other faiths or none restraint on self-interested politics
- liberty of conscience is compromised a state ethical order derived from
- dissent becomes impiety, not disagreement sacred obligation

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- SECULARISM — the state is not founded on the supremacy of one religious truth for all
- it protects equal citizenship, liberty of conscience and coexistence
- India: Articles 25-28 guarantee freedom of conscience and religion subject to
- public order, morality and health, and bar religious instruction in wholly
- State-funded institutions. — dated legal facts, not proof of a thesis).

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — internally valid for believers; as a GENERAL form of government in a plural modern society it fails consent, equal citizenship and revision.

05 STAGE 05 — DEMOCRACY: THE MODEL TAXONOMY AND THE PROTECTION OF MINORITIES

THE MODEL TAXONOMY AND THE PROTECTION OF MINORITIES · RULE OF THE PEOPLE · POLITICAL EQUALITY, CONSENT, PARTICIPATION, ACCOUNTABILITY, PUBLIC JUSTIFICATION AND PROTECTION · DIRECT REPRESENTATIVE PROCEDURAL SUBSTANTIVE CITIZENS CITIZENS ELECT ARE RULERS · HIGH WORKABLE AT SCALE, JUSTICE, RIGHTS, PARTICIPATION POWER STANDS · LIBERAL DEMOCRACY · POPULAR RULE + CONSTITUTIONAL LIMITS + RIGHTS + RULE · THE MAJORITY GOVERNS WITHOUT CONVERTING NUMBER INTO UNRESTRICTED POWER

DEFINITION — rule of the people: political equality, consent, participation, accountability, public justification and protection

DIRECT REPRESENTATIVE PROCEDURAL SUBSTANTIVE citizens citizens elect are rulers chosen do people actually decide rulers

elections, govern under fair themselves lawmakers competition, rules social conditions?

high workable at scale, justice, rights, participation power stands apart real equality

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DEFINITION — rule of the people: political equality, consent, participation, accountability, public justification and protection of rights
- DIRECT REPRESENTATIVE PROCEDURAL SUBSTANTIVE citizens citizens elect are rulers chosen do people actually decide rulers and fairly*
- elections, govern under fair themselves lawmakers competition, rules social conditions?
- high workable at scale justice, rights, participation power stands apart real equality

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- LIBERAL DEMOCRACY = popular rule + constitutional limits + rights + rule of law
- the majority governs WITHOUT converting number into unrestricted power
- ACHIEVEMENTS LIMITS lead guarantees, representation social prejudice outlasts formal equality judicial review, civil liberties incentives reward majoritarian
- rhetoric protected dissent and association formal tolerance. substantive exclusion constitutional accommodation delivery rests on constitutional culture

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- DEFERRING MODELS — PARTICIPATORY: participation educates citizens and resists alienation, echoing Mill on public character
- DELIBERATIVE: Habermas grounds legitimacy in public reasoning under freedom, reciprocity and absence of domination
- EPISTEMIC: procedures allow error-detection and revision
- INDIA ANCHOR — Ambedkar warns that political equality cannot long survive amid deep social and economic inequality.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIBERAL DEMOCRACY = popular rule + constitutional limits + rights + rule of law.

06 STAGE 06 — AUTHORITY AND LEGITIMACY: THE WEBERIAN GRID LAID ACROSS THE CLASSICAL ONE

AUTHORITY AND LEGITIMACY · THE WEBERIAN GRID LAID ACROSS THE CLASSICAL ONE · COMPLIANCE SECURED DESPITE RESISTANCE · POWER BELIEVED RIGHTFUL · GROUND OF BELIEF · SANCTITY OF · PERSONAL RETAINERS · IMMEMORIAL CUSTOM

POWER = compliance secured despite resistance	AUTHORITY = power believed RIGHTFUL		
TYPE	GROUND OF BELIEF	ADMINISTRATION	SUCCESSION
TRADITIONAL	sanctity of	personal retainers,	inheritance
immemorial custom	patrimonial staff	or custom	
CHARISMATIC	devotion to an	disciples chosen	acute; the
exceptional leader	personally, no rules	type is frail	

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- POWER = compliance secured despite resistance
- AUTHORITY = power believed RIGHTFUL
- GROUND OF BELIEF
- sanctity of
- personal retainers,

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- disciples chosen
- acute; the
- exceptional leader
- personally, no rules
- type is frail

EVALUATION / TRAP

- THE TYPOLOGY CUTS ACROSS THE CLASSICAL GRID monarchy — traditional, occasionally charismatic theocracy —
- traditional joined to charismatic democracy — normally legal-rational, yet capturable by plebiscitary charisma
- ROUTINISATION OF CHARISMA — movement becomes party becomes bureaucracy
- SCHUMPETER — democracy is the COMPETITIVE STRUGGLE FOR THE PEOPLE'S VOTE
- the people's function is to PRODUCE A GOVERNMENT, not to govern (procedural polit)

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION — a diagnostic grid only; no country, party, leader or period is judged.

07 STAGE 07 — POPULISM, ILLIBERAL DEMOCRACY AND THE MANUFACTURE OF CONSENT

POPULISM, ILLIBERAL DEMOCRACY AND THE MANUFACTURE OF CONSENT · DEFINITIONAL CONTEST · STATE IT, NEVER SETTLE IT SILENTLY · MUDDE (2004) · POPULISM AS A THIN-CENTRED IDEOLOGY · A PURE PEOPLE AGAINST A CORRUPT ELITE, ATTACHING TO · MÜLLER (2016) · THE DECISIVE MOVE IS EXCLUSIVE MORAL REPRESENTATION

DEFINITIONAL CONTEST — state it, never settle it silently → MUDDE (2004) — populism as a THIN-CENTRED ideology: a pure people against a corrupt elite → MÜLLER (2016) — the decisive move is EXCLUSIVE MORAL REPRESENTATION: rivals are not opponents but → LACLAU (2005) — populism as a LOGIC OF ARTICULATION binding unsatisfied demands into a collective → THE SLIDE, STEP BY STEP

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DEFINITIONAL CONTEST — state it, never settle it silently
- MUDDE (2004) — populism as a THIN-CENTRED ideology: a pure people against a corrupt elite, attaching to a HOST ideology across the spectrum
- MÜLLER (2016) — the decisive move is EXCLUSIVE MORAL REPRESENTATION: rivals are not opponents but enemies of the people (ANTI-PLURALISM)
- LACLAU (2005) — populism as a LOGIC OF ARTICULATION binding unsatisfied demands into a collective subject called the people
- THE SLIDE, STEP BY STEP

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- [4] courts, chambers, commissions, press and federal units become obstructions
- [5] they are weakened, captured or bypassed while elections continue
- [6] result — ILLIBERAL DEMOCRACY
- FORM RETAINED
- SUBSTANCE ERODED elections continue

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- plurality of ownership, absence of indirect pressure opposition parties exist
- a realistic prospect of alternation in power
- PROPAGANDA — a judgment is the citizen's own only under access to information, rival argument and freedom from manipulation
- otherwise consent is MANUFACTURED and a vote confers sociological legitimacy without normative authorisation
- REGULATOR'S DILEMMA — content-based remedies hand the state power over public truth, the very power a propagandising state abuses

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION — a diagnostic grid only; no country, party, leader or period is judged.

08 STAGE 08 — WHERE POWER SITS: UNITARY AGAINST FEDERAL DESIGN AND SUBSIDIARITY

WHERE POWER SITS · UNITARY AGAINST FEDERAL DESIGN AND SUBSIDIARITY · SECOND AXIS (COMPARATIVE SCAFFOLDING, CLEARLY LABELLED — NOT OWNED) · WHO RULES IS ONE QUESTION; WHERE POWER SITS AND · UNITARY <—————————— FEDERAL ONE CENTRAL GOVERNMENT: A CONSTITUTIONAL DIVISION · STABILISERS BICAMERALISM · A CHAMBER FOR THE UNITS A JUDICIAL UMPIRE OVER · COMING-TOGETHER FEDERATION

SECOND AXIS (comparative scaffolding, clearly labelled — not owned doctrine)

WHO RULES is one question; WHERE POWER SITS and HOW FAR DOWN it goes is

UNITARY <———————————— FEDERAL one central government

a constitutional DIVISION of powers sub-units exercise DELEGATED between centre and units, each with powers

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SECOND AXIS (comparative scaffolding, clearly labelled — not owned doctrine)
- WHO RULES is one question; WHERE POWER SITS and HOW FAR DOWN it goes is another
- UNITARY <———————————— FEDERAL one central government
- a constitutional DIVISION of powers sub-units exercise DELEGATED between centre and units, each with powers it may withdraw
- STABILISERS bicameralism: a chamber for the units a JUDICIAL UMPIRE over the centre-unit boundary fiscal and intergovernmental machinery

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- HOLDING-TOGETHER federation: one polity devolves to hold diversity
- FEDERATION (one indissoluble sovereignty) against CONFEDERATION
- sovereign members, exit possible, weak centre)
- SUBSIDIARITY — decide at the LOWEST capable level
- CENTRE — STATE / PROVINCE — DISTRICT — LOCAL SELF-GOVERNMENT

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- INDIA (dated legal facts) — Article 40 directs the State to organise village panchayats as units of self-government; the 73rd and 74th Constitutional
- Amendment Acts, 1992 added Parts IX and IX-A.
- India is a parliamentary, holding-together federal republic under CONSTITUTIONAL SUPREMACY with judicial review — never parliamentary sovereignty
- GANDHI — village self-rule (swaraj): self-reliant, participatory village republics
- CONTROL — keep the axis subordinate and return to source, purpose and limits.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONTROL — keep the axis subordinate and return to source, purpose and limits.

09 STAGE 09 — THE ANSWER SPINE: SHARED AXES, DIRECTIVE DECODER AND THE GRADED VERDICT

THE ANSWER SPINE · SHARED AXES, DIRECTIVE DECODER AND THE GRADED VERDICT · STEP 1 DEFINE · NAME THE FORM BY ITS SOURCE OF AUTHORITY, NOT · STEP 2 LOCATE · PLACE THE STIM ON THE CLASSICAL GRID AND THE · STEP 3 RIVALS · STAGE ONE REAL DEBATE, NEVER THREE DISCONNECTED MINI-ESSAYS

STEP 1 DEFINE — name the form by its SOURCE OF AUTHORITY, not by a → STEP 2 LOCATE — place the stim on the classical grid AND the legitimacy grid → STEP 3 RIVALS — stage ONE real debate, never three disconnected mini-essays → STEP 4 OBJECT — voice the strongest objection to your own thesis, then reply → STEP 5 EVIDENCE — one unit at 10 marks, two at 15, four or five at 20

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- STEP 1 DEFINE — name the form by its SOURCE OF AUTHORITY, not by a caricature
- STEP 2 LOCATE — place the stim on the classical grid AND the legitimacy grid
- STEP 3 RIVALS — stage ONE real debate, never three disconnected mini-essays
- STEP 4 OBJECT — voice the strongest objection to your own thesis, then reply
- STEP 5 EVIDENCE — one unit at 10 marks, two at 15, four or five at 20

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- treatment of dissent
- equal citizenship
- CAPACITY TO CORRECT ERROR <- the axis that usually decides and is usually left out
- DIRECTIVE DECODER — the verb fixes the structure
- Comment on — claim, argument, one objection, verdict

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT FORMULAS (adapt, never reproduce mechanically)
- ASYMMETRIC — the diagnosis survives, the remedy does not
- CRITERION — by consent and equal citizenship, theocratic sovereignty fails
- FORM/SUBSTANCE — the form is kept, the conditions worth having are not
- CROSS-TYPOLOGY — who decides, plus why they are obeyed

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Comment on — claim, argument, one objection, verdict.

10 STAGE 10 — INSTITUTIONAL FORM AXES INSIDE CONSTITUTIONAL GOVERNMENT

INSTITUTIONAL FORM AXES INSIDE CONSTITUTIONAL GOVERNMENT · EXECUTIVE-LEGISLATIVE FUSION PLUS COLLECTIVE RESPONSIBILITY · SEPARATE MANDATE, FIXED TENURE AND STRONGER SEPARATION · REMOVABILITY AND COORDINATION VERSUS STABILITY AND DEADLOCK · SUB-UNIT POWERS ARE DELEGATED AND LEGALLY WITHDRAWABLE · CENTRE AND UNITS HOLD CONSTITUTIONALLY DIVIDED COMPETENCES · COORDINATION MUST COEXIST WITH CHECKS AND REVIEW · SUBSIDIARITY, LOCAL KNOWLEDGE AND PARTICIPATION

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
PARLIAMENTARY — executive-legislative fusion plus collective responsibility	UNITARY — sub-unit powers are delegated and legally withdrawable	DECENTRALISATION — subsidiarity, local knowledge and participation
PRESIDENTIAL — separate mandate, fixed tenure and stronger separation	FEDERAL — centre and units hold constitutionally divided competences	CONTROL — no institutional axis by itself proves democratic legitimacy
TRADE-OFF — removability and coordination versus stability and deadlock	FUSION/SEPARATION — coordination must coexist with checks and review	

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- PARLIAMENTARY — executive-legislative fusion plus collective responsibility
- PRESIDENTIAL — separate mandate, fixed tenure and stronger separation
- TRADE-OFF — removability and coordination versus stability and deadlock

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- UNITARY — sub-unit powers are delegated and legally withdrawable
- FEDERAL — centre and units hold constitutionally divided competences
- FUSION/SEPARATION — coordination must coexist with checks and review

EVALUATION / TRAP

- DECENTRALISATION — subsidiarity, local knowledge and participation
- CONTROL — no institutional axis by itself proves democratic legitimacy

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONTROL — no institutional axis by itself proves democratic legitimacy.

11 STAGE 11 — NON-DEMOCRATIC REGIME FAMILIES AND THE SIX DEMOCRATIC PATHOLOGIES

NON-DEMOCRATIC REGIME FAMILIES AND THE SIX DEMOCRATIC PATHOLOGIES · CONCENTRATED RULE WITHOUT REGULAR COMPETITIVE ACCOUNTABILITY · RESTRICTED PLURALISM, OPPOSITION AND PUBLIC DISCUSSION · COMPREHENSIVE IDEOLOGY, MOBILISATION AND PARTY-STATE PENETRATION · MAJORITY TYRANNY · ELITE CAPTURE · INSTABILITY/SHORT-TERMISM POPULIST ANTI-PLURALISM · BUREAUCRATIC DOMINATION

DICTATORSHIP — concentrated rule without regular competitive accountability → AUTHORITARIANISM — restricted pluralism, opposition and public discussion → TOTALITARIANISM — comprehensive ideology, mobilisation and party-state penetration → PATHOLOGIES — majority tyranny → elite capture

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- DICTATORSHIP — concentrated rule without regular competitive accountability
- AUTHORITARIANISM — restricted pluralism, opposition and public discussion
- TOTALITARIANISM — comprehensive ideology, mobilisation and party-state penetration
- PATHOLOGIES — majority tyranny

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- elite capture
- instability/short-termism populist anti-pluralism
- bureaucratic domination
- COUNTERWEIGHTS — rights

EVALUATION / TRAP

- plural media
- transparency decentralisation
- realistic alternation in power
- VERDICT — democracy's strength is corrigibility, not immunity from error

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — democracy's strength is corrigibility, not immunity from error.

E EXTRA — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · ADVANCED SESSION 1 — THE CLASSIFICATION PROBLEM · WHO RULES, FOR WHOM, UNDER WHAT LIMITS · ADVANCED SESSION 2 — PLATO · THE DEGENERATION OF CONSTITUTIONS AND THE CRITIQUE OF DEMOCRACY · ADVANCED SESSION 3 — ARISTOTLE · THE SIX-FOLD MATRIX, ARISTOCRACY/OLIGARCHY AND THE POLITY · ADVANCED SESSION 4 — MONARCHY

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- ADVANCED SESSION 1 — The Classification Problem: Who Rules, For Whom, Under What Limits
- ADVANCED SESSION 2 — Plato: The Degeneration of Constitutions and the Critique of Democracy
- ADVANCED SESSION 3 — Aristotle: The Six-Fold Matrix, Aristocracy/Oligarchy and the Polity
- ADVANCED SESSION 4 — Monarchy: Absolute vs Constitutional, Freedom and the Above-Politics Claim

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- ADVANCED SESSION 5 — Theocracy: Divine Sovereignty, Secularism and the Validity Question
- ADVANCED SESSION 6 — Democracy: Models, Institutional Forms and Minority Protection
- ADVANCED SESSION 7 — Authority, Legitimacy and the Non-Democratic Forms (Weber, Schumpeter, Michels)
- ADVANCED SESSION 8 — Populism, Illiberal Democracy and Propaganda

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- ADVANCED SESSION 9 — Institutional and Territorial Design: Federal/Unitary, Decentralisation and Inter-Form Debates
- ADVANCED SESSION 10 — Mixed/Constitutional Government: Criteria of Evaluation and the Comparative Verdict
- ADVANCED DOSSIER REFINEMENTS — USE SELECTIVELY
- Core prerequisite: Monarchy, theocracy and democracy as named syllabus terms

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.